



UNITED STATES
Just days after the MGM v Grokster case, select consumer electronics chains began stocking Slingbox, a brick-sized device that enables viewers to route live television signals to a portable device anywhere on the globe via broadband. Slingbox costs just \$250 (Rs 10,900). Several stores sold out on the first day in L.A.

UAE
Dubai is the next tech powerhouse, according to Ghazi Benothman, a founding partner in Minah Ventures, a venture firm. Dubai is laying the groundwork to become a development centre for advanced semiconductors, decompression algorithms and other high-end products.

JAPAN
Convenience stores could, in a few years, be selling downloadable music and movies. FamilyMart, the third-biggest of Japan's convenience store chains, said it will invest ¥31 billion (Rs 121 crore) to set up a fibre-optic network offering broadband services at its 6,000 stores in Japan.

ISRAEL
American companies in Israel are discovering a new source of highly skilled workers for their call centres. StartUp Jerusalem (SUJ), a non-profit organisation seeking to revitalise Jerusalem and create jobs in all communities by attracting investments to the city is determined to turn Jerusalem into a world class centre for outsourcing.

HONG KONG
18 months since the first 3G services were rolled out, the situation isn't great. Industry observers paint a grim picture—with local telecoms players racking up huge losses and struggling to recoup their huge outlays on 3G licences and infrastructure because of patchy sales of handsets and services.

NEW ZEALAND
Wellington is a hacker's paradise. More than 50 big-name companies there have wide open Wi-Fi networks. Security outfit Aura Software Security, in a publicity stunt, drove through Wellington with sniffers on. It found 50 corporate networks completely wide open, and others had a very low level of security.

IS IT A BIRD? IS IT A PLANE?

Swarm Intelligence

One of these days, don't be surprised if you look up in the sky and see a fleet of tiny, robotic helicopters capable of swarming like angry bees over your home. This could

soon be reality if researchers in Britain have their way.

The researchers are using Linux and embedded processors to build their fleets, and the Ultra Swarm project of the University of Essex is an experiment in swarm intelligence and wireless cluster computing. This,



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj



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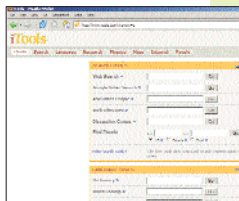
www.cprogramming.com



Cprogramming.com

A comprehensive site for C/C++ users, beginners and experts alike. The site provides plenty of tutorials and sample code. The 'Tools' section is a handy guide for beginners. There are tutorials that are like virtual classrooms for virtually every concept and fundamental of C/C++, including Object-Oriented Paradigms.

www.itools.com



Ittools.com

A search engine with a world of a difference. There are different search categories such as Web, people, encyclopaedias, etc. There is a Dictionary, People Search, and a translator. The interface is categorised into 'Search Tools', 'Language Tools' and 'Research Tools'—no more complex search queries!

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